

ADR-006: Narrative First (Narrative Before Analytics)

Project Genesis Research Repository

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Context

When designing research portals, it is common to prioritize complex dashboards and visual data plots first. However, Genesis is a storytelling simulation of emergent behaviors. A pure dashboard risks obscuring the human-readable chronicle of events under tables and charts, making experiments feel like simple database entries rather than history.

Decision

We establish a rule: Evidence must support the narrative, not replace it.

- All Civilization Records must present the narrative (Question, Hypothesis, Outcome, and Chronicle) prior to showing analytical graphs.
- Analytical visualizations are decoupled into the Observatory mode.
- Users must understand what happened through narrative before exploring why it happened through charts.

Consequences

- Preserves the distinct storytelling-first identity of Genesis.
- Simplifies the initial layout of Civilization Records.
- Prevents the interface from becoming cluttered like a corporate business intelligence tool.